LARGE LANGUAGE MODEL ADVANCED PROMPT ENGINEERING (SERIES A)

EXHIBIT 01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY PROMPT OPTIMIZATION

ETHAN MICHAEL

PROMPT ENGINEER || AI SYSTEM ANALYST

Iterative Instruction Design, Model Behavior Analysis, and Generative System Testing

FOREWORD

All exhibits are processed on clean, public, accountless ChatGPT base Large Language Model (LLM) sessions for both transparency's and concept's sakes (as, this setup is most exemplary of the common User). The implements herein can be even further bolstered via personalizing User account preferences (i.e. maintaining LLM formal Saved Memory; defining User personal information and overall operational direction; designating model Personality presets).

As of time of writing, richer features such as adding files (except photo files); deeper researching and "Thinking" modes; AI image generation; and higher-functioning base models are only available when logged-in, with a User account, to the ChatGPT platform. This is common across LLM services. Regardless, the information, herein, applies across models and services alike and should be treated with such regard.

OBJECTIVE

Show how a simple, unqualified request compares to a refined prompt that supplies role and focus; and how to iterate upon improved initial instructions (AKA, "chain" prompts). Measure clarity, accuracy, and structure.

User Prompt (v1)

"Summarize the following article and earnings statement in 10 bullet points: [raw article] [raw statement]"

LLM Output (v1)

"Here's a 10-point summary of Apple's Q2 2025 earnings report:

1. Revenue Growth: Apple reported $95.4 billion in revenue for Q2 2025, a 5% increase year-over-year.

2. Record EPS: Earnings per share (EPS) reached $1.65, marking a March quarter record and an 8% increase from Q2 2024.

3. Services Surge: Services revenue hit an all-time high at $26.6 billion, showing double-digit growth compared to the previous year.

4. iPhone & Hardware Updates: The quarter saw the launch of the iPhone 16e, and new Macs and iPads powered by Apple Silicon.

5. Environmental Milestone: Apple announced a 60% reduction in carbon emissions over the past decade.

6. Strong Cash Flow: Apple generated $24 billion in operating cash flow, and returned $29 billion to shareholders through dividends and stock buybacks.

7. New Shareholder Initiatives: The board approved a 4% dividend increase (to $0.26 per share) and authorized a $100 billion stock repurchase program.

8. Global Sales Performance: Revenue increased across most geographic segments, with notable growth in the Americas, Japan, and Rest of Asia Pacific, while Greater China revenue declined slightly.

9. Device Ecosystem Growth: Apple's installed base of active devices reached a new all-time high across all product categories and regions.

10. Balance Sheet Highlights: Apple ended the quarter with $28.2 billion in cash, down from $29.9 billion in September 2024, and reduced liabilities, including a drop in commercial paper and term debt."

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Summarize the following article and earnings statement in 10 bullet points:

"PRESS RELEASE May 1, 2025 Apple reports second quarter results Services revenue reaches new all-time high EPS sets March quarter record https://nr.apple.com/Dw7W5N5zi5 CUPERTINO, CALIFORNIA Apple today announced financial results for its fiscal 2025 second quarter ended March 29, 2025. The Company posted quarterly revenue of $95.4 billion, up 5 percent year over year, and quarterly diluted earnings per share of $1.65, up 8 percent year over year. "Today Apple is reporting strong quarterly results, including double-digit growth in Services," said Tim Cook, Apple's CEO. "We were happy to welcome iPhone 16e to our lineup, and to introduce powerful new Macs and iPads that take advantage of the extraordinary capabilities of Apple silicon. And we were proud to announce that we've cut our carbon emissions by 60 percent over the past decade."
"Our March quarter business performance drove EPS growth of 8 percent and $24 billion in operating cash flow, allowing us to return $29 billion to shareholders," said Kevan Parekh, Apple's CFO. "And thanks to our high levels of customer loyalty and satisfaction, our installed base of active devices once again reached a new all-time high

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once again reached a new all-time high across all product categories and geographic segments." Apple's board of directors has declared a cash dividend of $0.26 per share of the Company's common stock, an increase of 4 percent. The dividend is payable on May 15, 2025 to shareholders of record as of the close of business on May 12, 2025. The board of directors has also authorized an additional program to repurchase up to $100 billion of the Company's common stock. Apple will provide live streaming of its Q2 2025 financial results conference call beginning at 2:00 p.m. PT on May 1, 2025 at apple.com/investor/earnings-call. The webcast will be available for replay for approximately two weeks thereafter. Apple Inc. CONDENSED CONSOLIDATED STATEMENTS OF OPERATIONS (Unaudited) (In millions, except number of shares, which are reflected in thousands, and per-share amounts) Three Months Ended Six Months Ended March 29, 2025 March 30, 2024 March 29, 2025 March 30, 2024 Net sales: Products $ 68,714 $ 66,886 $ 166,674 $ 163,344 Services 26,645 23,867 52,985 46,984 Total net sales (1) 95,359 90,753 219,659 210,328 Cost of sales: Products 44,030 42,424 103,477 100,864 Services 6,462 6,058 13,040 12,338 Total cost of sales 50,492 48,482 116,517 113,202 Gross margin 44,867 42,271 103,142 97,126 Operating expenses: Research and development 8,550 7,903 16,818 15,599 Selling, general and administrative 6,728 6,468 13,903 13,254 Total operating expenses 15,278 14,371 30,721 28,853 Operating income 29,589 27,900 72,421 68,273 Other income/(expense), net (279) 158 (527) 108 Income before provision for income taxes 29,310 28,058 71,894 68,381 Provision for income taxes 4,530 4,422 10,784 10,829 Net income $ 24,780 $ 23,636

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income taxes 4,530 4,422 10,784 10,829 Net income $ 24,780 $ 23,636 $ 61,110 $ 57,552 Earnings per share: Basic $ 1.65 $ 1.53 $ 4.06 $ 3.72 Diluted $ 1.65 $ 1.53 $ 4.05 $ 3.71 Shares used in computing earnings per share: Basic 14,994,082 15,405,856 15,037,903 15,457,810 Diluted 15,056,133 15,464,709 15,103,499 15,520,675 (1) Net sales by reportable segment: Americas $ 40,315 $ 37,273 $ 92,963 $ 87,703 Europe 24,454 24,123 58,315 54,520 Greater China 16,002 16,372 34,515 37,191 Japan 7,298 6,262 16,285 14,029 Rest of Asia Pacific 7,290 6,723 17,581 16,885 Total net sales $ 95,359 $ 90,753 $ 219,659 $ 210,328 (1) Net sales by category: iPhone $ 46,841 $ 45,963 $ 115,979 $ 115,665 Mac 7,949 7,451 16,936 15,231 iPad 6,402 5,559 14,490 12,582 Wearables, Home and Accessories 7,522 7,913 19,269 19,866 Services 26,645 23,867 52,985 46,984 Total net sales $ 95,359 $ 90,753 $ 219,659 $ 210,328 Apple Inc. CONDENSED CONSOLIDATED BALANCE SHEETS (Unaudited) (In millions, except number of shares, which are reflected in thousands, and par value) March 29, 2025 September 28, 2024 ASSETS: Current assets: Cash and cash equivalents $ 28,162 $ 29,943 Marketable securities 20,336 35,228 Accounts receivable, net 26,136 33,410 Vendor non-trade receivables 23,662 32,833 Inventories 6,269 7,286 Other current assets 14,109 14,287 Total current assets 118,674 152,987 Non-current assets: Marketable securities 84,424 91,479 Property, plant and equipment, net 46,876 45,680 Other non-current assets 81,259 74,834 Total non-current assets 212,559 211,993 Total assets $ 331,233 $ 364,980 LIABILITIES AND SHAREHOLDERS' EQUITY: Current liabilities: Accounts payable 4,126 $ 68,960 Other current liabilities 61,849 78,304 Deferred revenue 8,976 8,249 Commercial paper 5,982 9,967

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(Unaudited) (In millions) Six Months Ended March 29, 2025 March 30, 2024 Cash, cash equivalents, and restricted cash and cash equivalents, beginning balances $ 29,943 $ 30,737 Operating activities: Net income 61,110 57,552 Adjustments to reconcile net income to cash generated by operating activities: Depreciation and amortization 5,741 5,684 Share-based compensation expense 6,512 5,961 Other (2,217) (1,971) Changes in operating assets and liabilities: Accounts receivable, net 7,266 7,727 Vendor non-trade receivables 9,171 12,164 Inventories 858 53 Other current and non-current assets (4,371) (4,438) Accounts payable (14,604) (16,710) Other current and non-current liabilities (15,579) (3,437) Cash generated by operating activities 53,887 62,585 Investing activities: Purchases of marketable securities (12,442) (25,042) Proceeds from maturities of marketable securities 26,587 27,462 Proceeds from sales of marketable securities 5,210 4,314 Payments for acquisition of property, plant and equipment (6,011) (4,388) Other (635) (729) Cash generated by investing activities 12,709 1,617 Financing activities: Payments for taxes related to net share settlement of equity awards (3,205) (2,875) Payments for dividends and dividend equivalents (7,614) (7,535) Repurchases of common stock (49,504) (43,344) Repayments of term debt (4,009) (3,150) Repayments of commercial paper, net (3,968) (3,982) Other (77) (132) Cash used in financing activities (68,377) (61,018) Increase/(Decrease) in cash, cash equivalents, and restricted cash and cash equivalents (1,781) 3,184 Cash, cash equivalents, and restricted cash and cash equivalents, ending balances $ 28,162 $ 33,921 Supplemental cash flow disclosure: Cash paid for income taxes, net $ 31,683 $ 14,531"

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3. Services Surge: Services revenue hit an all-time high at $26.6 billion, showing double-digit growth compared to the previous year.
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5. Environmental Milestone: Apple announced a 60% reduction in carbon emissions over the past decade.
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10. Balance Sheet Highlights: Apple ended the quarter with $28.2 billion in cash, down from $29.9 billion in September 2024, and reduced liabilities, including a drop in commercial paper and term debt.

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Result Summary

General lack of specificity in Input prompt causes generative AI agent to guess at which information, in the provided data, is relevant to the User's needs. The model produced coherent, correctly numbered bullets with accurate data, but tone and focus drifted towards narrative style; and key business metrics were lost to ambiguity. Paraphrasing of Tim Cook quotes — blended with factual and promotional language — led to omission of critical details.

METRIC	SCORE (1–10)	COMMENT
ACCURACY	**8**	Figures are correct, but hallucination occurred ("Rest of Asia Pacific" is a misnomer)
TONE / FOCUS	**5**	Too journalistic; no precise direction
CONCISENESS	**5**	OK length, but bullets are too longwinded
STRUCTURE	**10**	Properly numbered bullet format

Weighted Score 0.7 / 1.0

Observed Weaknesses

- Mixed executive summary with journalistic / PR tone
- No consistent data metric emphasis/es
- Hallucination present in summary

User Prompt (v2)

"Simulate that you are a financial analyst preparing a quarterly summary for Apple's board.
Summarize the following press release in exactly 10 bullet points.
Each bullet must contain at least one quantitative figure or verified fact — exclude quotations and promotional wording; maintain a neutral, report-style tone.
Keep bullet points as concise as possible — focusing on data clarity over descriptive or grammatical filler wording.
Focus only on the core business health parameters (e.g. revenue growth; profitability; earnings per share; cash flow; segment performance; balance sheet strength; shareholder returns; and company guidance/forward-looking statements and innovation/risk ecosystems):
[raw article] [raw statement]"

LLM Output (v2)

"Apple Inc. – Fiscal Q2 2025 Financial Summary
Prepared for Board Review
1. Revenue Growth: Total Q2 revenue was $95.4 billion, a 5% increase year-over-year from $90.8 billion.
2. Earnings Performance: Diluted earnings per share reached $1.65, marking an 8% year-over-year increase and a March quarter record.
3. Services Expansion: Services revenue hit an all-time high of $26.6 billion, growing 11.6% from $23.9 billion in Q2 2024.
4. iPhone Segment: iPhone revenue rose to $46.8 billion, a 1.9% increase year-over-year.
5. Operating Cash Flow: Apple generated $24 billion in operating cash flow during the quarter.
6. Shareholder Returns: $29 billion was returned to shareholders in Q2 via dividends and share repurchases.
7. Buyback Authorization: The board approved a new $100 billion share repurchase program.
8. Dividend Increase: Cash dividend per share was raised 4% to $0.26, payable May 15, 2025.
9. Profitability Metrics: Gross margin reached $44.9 billion, up from $42.3 billion in Q2 2024; net income was $24.8 billion, up 4.8% year-over-year.
10. Balance Sheet Update: Total assets declined to $331.2 billion from $365.0 billion in September 2024, while shareholders' equity increased to $66.8 billion from $57.0 billion."

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Apple today announced financial results for its fiscal 2025 second quarter ended March 29, 2025. The Company posted quarterly revenue of $95.4 billion, up 5 percent year over year, and quarterly diluted earnings per share of $1.65, up 8 percent year over year. "Today Apple is reporting strong quarterly results, including double-digit growth in Services," said Tim Cook, Apple's CEO. "We were happy to welcome iPhone 16e to our lineup, and to introduce powerful new Macs and iPads that take advantage of the extraordinary capabilities of Apple silicon. And we were proud to announce that we've cut our carbon emissions by 60 percent over the past decade." "Our March quarter business performance drove EPS growth of 8 percent and $24 billion in operating cash flow, allowing us to return $29 billion to shareholders," said Kevan Parekh, Apple's CFO. "And thanks to our high levels of customer loyalty and satisfaction, our installed base of active devices once again reached a new all-time high across all product categories and geographic segments." Apple's board of directors has declared a cash dividend of $0.26 per share of the Company's common stock, an increase of 4 percent. The dividend is payable on May 15, 2025 to shareholders of record as of the close of business on May 12, 2025. The board of directors has also authorized an additional program to repurchase up to $100 billion of the Company's common stock. Apple will provide live streaming of its Q2 2025 financial results conference call beginning at 2:00 p.m. PT on May 1, 2025 at apple.com/investor/earnings-call. The webcast will be available for replay for approximately two weeks thereafter. Apple Inc. CONDENSED CONSOLIDATED STATEMENTS OF OPERATIONS (Unaudited) (In millions, except number of shares, which are reflected in thousands, and per-

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Apple Inc. – Fiscal Q2 2025 Financial Summary

Prepared for Board Review

1. **Revenue Growth:** Total Q2 revenue was $95.4 billion, a 5% increase year-over-year from $90.8 billion.
2. **Earnings Performance:** Diluted earnings per share reached $1.65, marking an 8% year-over-year increase and a March quarter record.
3. **Services Expansion:** Services revenue hit an all-time high of $26.6 billion, growing 11.6% from $23.9 billion in Q2 2024.
4. **iPhone Segment:** iPhone revenue rose to $46.8 billion, a 1.9% increase year-over-year.
5. **Operating Cash Flow:** Apple generated $24 billion in operating cash flow during the quarter.
6. **Shareholder Returns:** $29 billion was returned to shareholders in Q2 via dividends and share repurchases.
7. **Buyback Authorization:** The board approved a new $100 billion share repurchase program.
8. **Dividend Increase:** Cash dividend per share was raised 4% to $0.26, payable May 15, 2025.
9. **Profitability Metrics:** Gross margin reached $44.9 billion, up from $42.3 billion in Q2 2024; net income was $24.8 billion, up 4.8% year-over-year.
10. **Balance Sheet Update:** Total assets declined to $331.2 billion from $365.0 billion in September 2024, while shareholders' equity increased to $66.8 billion from $57.0 billion.

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Result Summary

Better specificity in Input prompt causes generative AI agent to anchor to relevant information and ignore alternatives irrelevant to the User's needs. The model continues to produce correctly numbered bullets and data accuracy, but, now, with desirable insights. However, commanding, initial prompting is not enough to remove filler wording even upon initial request; iterative methodology is required moving forward (i.e. ***see****: v2.1 below).*

METRIC	SCORE (1–10)	COMMENT
ACCURACY	**10**	Figures are correct; no hallucination
TONE / FOCUS	**8**	Less journalistic; followed precise direction; but embellishment remains
CONCISENESS	**8**	Good length, but bullets are still too verbose
STRUCTURE	**10**	Properly numbered bullet format

Weighted Score 0.9 / 1.0

Observed Weaknesses

- Unwanted embellishment still present in model Output
- Length of Output still not optimized as User requested

User Prompt (v2.1 — Iterative Method)

"Condense your wording down to data points only; do not embellish with filler words.
Examples:
'Revenue Growth: Total Q2 revenue was $95.4 billion, a 5% increase year-over-year from $90.8 billion' should be more akin to 'Revenue Growth (Q2): 5% increase (YoY); $90.8 billion (2024) → $95.4 billion (2025)'
'Earnings Performance: Diluted earnings per share reached $1.65, marking an 8% year-over-year increase and a March quarter record' should be more akin to 'Earnings Performance: Diluted earnings / share — $1.65; 8% increase (YoY) [March Quarter record]'"

LLM Output (v2.1)

"Apple Inc. — Fiscal Q2 2025 Summary (Data-Only Format)

1. Revenue Growth (Q2): 5% increase (YoY); $90.8B (2024) → $95.4B (2025)
2. Earnings Performance: Diluted earnings / share — $1.65; 8% increase (YoY) [March quarter record]
3. Services Revenue (Q2): $26.6B; 11.6% increase (YoY); $23.9B (2024)
4. iPhone Revenue (Q2): $46.8B; 1.9% increase (YoY); $45.96B (2024)
5. Operating Cash Flow (Q2): $24B
6. Shareholder Returns (Q2): $29B returned; includes buybacks + dividends
7. Stock Buyback Authorization: $100B approved for repurchase
8. Dividend (Declared): $0.26/share; 4% increase; payable May 15, 2025
9. Net Income (Q2): $24.8B; 4.8% increase (YoY); $23.6B (2024)
10. Total Assets vs Equity: Assets — $331.2B (↓ from $365.0B); Equity — $66.8B (↑ from $57.0B)"

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September 2024, and reduced liabilities, including a drop in commercial paper and term debt.

Condense your wording down to data points only; do not embellish with filler words.
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3. Services Revenue (Q2): $26.6B; 11.6% increase (YoY); $23.9B (2024)
4. iPhone Revenue (Q2): $46.8B; 1.9% increase (YoY); $45.96B (2024)
5. Operating Cash Flow (Q2): $24B

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Apple Inc. — Fiscal Q2 2025 Summary (Data-Only Format)

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5. Operating Cash Flow (Q2): $24B
6. Shareholder Returns (Q2): $29B returned; includes buybacks + dividends
7. Stock Buyback Authorization: $100B approved for repurchase
8. Dividend (Declared): $0.26/share; 4% increase; payable May 15, 2025
9. Net Income (Q2): $24.8B; 4.8% increase (YoY); $23.6B (2024)
10. Total Assets vs Equity: Assets — $331.2B (↓ from $365.0B); Equity — $66.8B (↑ from $57.0B)

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Result Summary (v2.1)

Desired Output is achieved via only two, short examples of refinement (via precise iterative methodology). Providing the LLM with exact formatting guidelines results in perfected Output.

METRIC	SCORE (1–10)	COMMENT
ACCURACY	**10**	Figures are correct; no hallucination
TONE / FOCUS	**10**	Only raw data figures present
CONCISENESS	**10**	Perfect length; easy to read; no interpretative filler
STRUCTURE	**10**	Properly numbered bullet format

Weighted Score 1.0 / 1.0

Observed Weaknesses

- N/A

FINAL ANALYSIS

The User's desired Output
was achieved with minimal effort.

*Better specificity (User Prompt v2) was enough to increase the total weighted quality score of an initial prompt by **28.57%** ; and just a single employment of iterative refinement transformed narrative-style, convoluted Output into executive-grade data reporting (User Prompt v2.1 — Iterative Method) — a **42.86%** increase in weighted quality score over the initial prompt (User Prompt v1) .*

This exhibit shows that specificity and concentrated iteration upon prompts produces perfect results (not initial, required parameters alone). Too much or too little information, in the primary engagement with a model, is insufficient to produce a perfectly refined, clear summary; this fact, alone, is enough to confuse untrained LLM Users.